

What You Can Make with Claude

faculty projects, ordered from familiar text toward unfamiliar code — and past it

A review of what faculty are building, arranged on one axis. It begins in the writing you already command and descends toward forms that did not exist two years ago. Each row is a genre of output. Examples at left. One project **unpacked** at right: situation, inputs, operations, outputs, and the interface suited to it ([CHAT](#) [COWORK](#) [CODE](#)). The loop is constant — inputs, operations, outputs. Only the medium changes. Begin where you are fluent. Descend.

1 Structured Text & Documents

MOST FAMILIAR

EXAMPLES

- Email to a chair proposing a new course
- Grant Specific Aims page from a project description
- Committee report from raw meeting notes
- Recommendation letter from a CV and a prompt
- Conference abstract from a draft paper
- Syllabus skeleton from a reading list

UNPACKED

Meeting notes → a clean report for the dean

SITUATION	Messy notes from a faculty meeting; a structured report due tomorrow.
INPUTS	meeting-notes.md — your raw bullet points.
OPERATIONS	One prompt: "turn these into a report with a summary, decisions made, and action items with owners and dates."
OUTPUTS	report.md, or a polished .docx on request.
BEST FIT	CHAT COWORK CODE IF REPEATED MONTHLY

2 Reference Pages static HTML

INTRO TO CODE

EXAMPLES

- A searchable glossary of course terms
- A one-page syllabus website
- A printable command/reference dashboard
- An illustrated lecture handout
- A course-policy FAQ page

UNPACKED

A glossary your students can search and copy from

SITUATION	One page holding every key term in your course, searchable, works offline.
INPUTS	glossary.md — terms and definitions.
OPERATIONS	"Build a single-file HTML page with a search box and click-to-copy, styled for comfortable reading."
OUTPUTS	glossary.html — one file you can email or host anywhere.
BEST FIT	CODE COWORK

3 Web Apps Next.js

MORE COMPLEX

EXAMPLES

- A course website with interactive concept demos
- A reading-response collection app
- An interactive timeline of a period or movement
- A "build your own X" student exercise

UNPACKED

Course site for GENED 1049 East Asian Cinema

SITUATION	A site pairing a cinematography glossary with demos built on the films you actually teach.
INPUTS	Syllabus, Rashomon stills, glossary text.
OPERATIONS	Scaffold a Next.js app, build parametric demo components, deploy to Vercel.
OUTPUTS	A live site (gened-1049.vercel.app) you share by link.
BEST FIT	CODE

Turn over. The axis continues: connected tools, visualization, orchestration. Then it leaves the page.

...and further down the spine

connected tools, visualizations, agentic systems — and what's past the bottom edge

4 Bots & Connected ToolsMCP, Slack

TODAY'S TOPIC

EXAMPLES ■ Claude connected to Semantic Scholar for live literature search ■ An art-history lecture pulling live images from Harvard Art Museums ■ A Slack bot that answers from your course materials ■ An oral-exam practice bot ■ Claude connected to your Google Drive	UNPACKED An art-history lecture, illustrated from the museum's own records
	SITUATION Plain lecture notes name a dozen works. The illustrated page must show the real objects — fetched, not remembered.
	INPUTS The lecture notes; a free Harvard Art Museums API key in <code>.mcp.json</code> .
	OPERATIONS A custom MCP gives Claude the museum's search and object tools. It looks up each work, pulls images and tombstone metadata, builds the page.
	OUTPUTS An illustrated lecture page where every image and caption traces to an accession record.
	BEST FIT CODE MCP SERVERS RUN HERE

5 Data Visualizationsd3, three.js

EVEN MORE COMPLEX

EXAMPLES ■ A 2D semantic-embedding map of a text corpus ■ An interactive chart of course-evaluation trends ■ A 3D model of a molecule, artifact, or building ■ A network graph of citations or characters ■ An animated explainer for a hard concept	UNPACKED Calvino's <i>Six Memos</i>, by the numbers
	SITUATION Students see literary qualities as a measurable space — and plot their own prose against it.
	INPUTS The five memos as text; definitions for each measure.
	OPERATIONS Deterministic text analysis + a 2D embedding map + a live draft composer, charts drawn in d3.
	OUTPUTS A live page where pasted prose appears in every chart in real time.
	BEST FIT CODE

6 Agentic Pipelines & Systems

MOST COMPLEX

EXAMPLES ■ Close-reading a whole corpus with parallel subagents ■ A reproducible coding pipeline for interview transcripts ■ An automated weekly research digest (scheduled) ■ A recommendation engine grounded in institutional data	UNPACKED Naming every writer cited across 538 Dylan songs
	SITUATION A close reading at corpus scale — every author named in any lyric, with the line quoted — not a keyword grep.
	INPUTS The full corpus of songs (or transcripts, or a long text).
	OPERATIONS Spawn parallel close-reading subagents, each told to read like a scholar and refuse to grep; aggregate.
	OUTPUTS One aggregated JSON plus a prose writeup pairing each name with its quoted line.
	BEST FIT CODE SUBAGENTS, SCALE

? The Gesamtkunstwerk

BEYOND THE MAP

Wagner, 1849: the **Gesamtkunstwerk** — every medium under one composition. Music, image, poetry, architecture, a single designed experience. The opera house was engineered for it. The ambition outlived its instruments.

The instruments have changed. Each category on this axis is a medium one person can now compose — document, page, application, visualization, system. Past the bottom edge lies their unification: the course whose site, handouts, archive, and room operate as one designed system; the exhibition that computes; the seminar whose documentation is itself the work. Mixed media. Single composition. Real space.

No worked example exists. The category is open.

The whole axis is one loop: inputs, operations, outputs. Descent changes a single variable — how much of the loop is code. Worked versions of most rows live in this repo's [examples/more-examples/](#).